SETTLED DAYS

PARENTS' MOVE COMMAND CENTER

Moving your parent, one calm page at a time.

For the weeks when you are doing this between work and everything else - start with just three things today. The rest can wait its turn.

WHAT THIS KIT HOLDS

Measure the new home first - so nothing makes a return trip (p.6)

The First Night Box and the small things that make it home (p.11)

Six calm ways to sort a house full of years (p.15)

One family claims list, one deadline for everyone (p.23)

Every box numbered, every paper's location written down (p.27, p.30)

Your parent decides - their home, their things, their call (p.33)

Three honest paths - including "move first, sort later." Your family's way is a real way. Work through the pages in the order your move needs them, not the order they are printed in.

TWO WAYS TO USE EVERY PAGE

Type in it: the writing lines and checkboxes are fillable fields - type in your PDF reader, then save. Or print it: the same lines are ruled for handwriting, in plain black and white that is easy on home ink. Text is large and high-contrast on purpose - designed for reading and filling in together.

43 pages. US Letter and A4 editions included. Instant download - nothing is shipped. Personal use only.

How to Use This Kit - and Please Read

Two minutes on this page will save you hunting later. It also holds the one thing we ask every family to read before they start.

PLEASE READ - WHAT THIS PLANNER IS, AND IS NOT

This planner is an organizing tool. It is not legal, financial, or medical advice, and it cannot make decisions for your family. It never tells you how to create or change a will, a power of attorney, or a care plan - page 30 only records where documents are kept and who holds them. For wills, powers of attorney, care decisions, and anything that needs a signature, please talk to a lawyer, the community's office, or a doctor. Never write account numbers, passwords, or ID numbers in this planner - locations only, always.

HOW THE KIT IS ORGANIZED

- Start Here (p.3-5) - pick your path, hold one calm first meeting.
- Measure the New Home First (p.6-10) - rooms, rules, and what fits.
- The First Days (p.11-14) - the first-night box, familiar rhythms, contacts.
- Sorting the House (p.15-21) - six ways an item can go, room by room.
- Family, Together (p.22-26) - who does what, claims, quotes, updates.
- Move Day and Settling In (p.27-29) - boxes, the day itself, week one.
- Closing the Old Home (p.30-32) - papers, close-out, the 30-day review.
- Your Parent, and You (p.33-34) - their decisions, and a page for you.
- Quick Start and worked example (p.35-38). Command sheets (p.39-40).
- AI photo inventory prompt cards (p.41-42). Printable box labels (p.43).

PRINTING AND FILLING TIPS

- Print at 100% (actual size). Print single pages as you reach them - you do not need the whole kit on paper at once.
- To type instead of write: open the PDF in a desktop reader (the free Adobe Acrobat Reader saves filled forms most reliably). Some browser and phone previews let you type but cannot save - if your answers disappear, switch to a desktop reader.
- This file is made for your paper size - Letter and A4 are separate, native editions, not rescaled copies.
- Keep one printed copy where the whole family can reach it. A move runs better when the plan is not inside one person's phone.

Start Here: Which Path Are You On?

For the night the decision is made and your head is spinning. Start on this page - nowhere else. Every move like this takes one of three paths. Find yours, do the three things listed under it, and stop for today.

PATH A - PLANNED MOVE (about 6-8 weeks)

Your parent has time, and so do you. Work through the kit in order.

- [ ] Book a first visit to the new home - and ask for the written list of what can and cannot be brought.
- [ ] Measure the new rooms (page 6) before you sort a single box.
- [ ] Set one date for a first family conversation, and tell everyone the date.

PATH B - MOVE-IN WITHIN TWO WEEKS

A room opened up, or health changed the timeline. Skip ahead: pages 6, 11 and 30 come first.

- [ ] Write the First Night Box list (page 11). Packing it can wait a day; the list cannot.
- [ ] Measure only the big furniture (page 6) - the pieces that cannot make a return trip.
- [ ] Write down where the important papers are (page 30). Locations only, ten minutes.

PATH C - MOVE FIRST, SORT THE HOUSE LATER

Your parent moves in with the essentials now, and the house gets sorted over the coming weeks. This is a real plan, not a failed one - many families do it this way.

- [ ] Take essentials only. Everything else stays put, safely, for now.
- [ ] Set a review date for the house, and write down who holds the keys.
- [ ] Tell the family the plan in one message, so nobody freelances.

If two minutes is all you have, page 2 explains how this kit works and what it can and cannot do. Then come back here - this page is the front door, and every path starts at it.

The First Family Conversation

For the first time everyone sits down together - often the hardest hour of the whole move. You do not have to find the words on the spot. They are on this page; read them out if that is easier. Nobody has to win this meeting. It only has to end with a path, a lead name, and a next date.

BEFORE ANYONE SITS DOWN

- [ ] Your parent is at this table as a decision-maker, not as the topic. If they want a smaller first talk - just you and them - that comes first, and that is fine.
- [ ] Agree on one note-taker. Decisions live on paper (this page), not in four different memories.
- [ ] Anything that turns heated gets parked on page 24 with a date to revisit it. Parking a question is not losing it.

THE FIVE THINGS TO SETTLE, IN ORDER

1. The path.
Planned, two-week, or move-first-sort-later (page 3). Say it out loud, once, so everyone works from the same plan.

2. The lead.
One person coordinates. Helpers help; the lead keeps the lists. Write the name below.

3. Your parent's lines.
The things that are not negotiable - ask, listen, write them down in their words. Page 33 gives them a page of their own, too.

4. Money, in the open.
Who pays for movers, cleaning, and any storage - and how it gets settled later. One honest paragraph now prevents a year of quiet resentment.

5. The next date.
When you will all look at progress together (page 26 is the update page). Book it before anyone leaves the table.

Move lead: _____ **Move-in date:** _____

YOUR PARENT'S NON-NEGOTIABLES (their words)

MONEY - WHAT WE AGREED, IN ONE PLACE

The Whole Move on One Page

For the fridge door. Seven phases, one owner each, one date each. When someone asks "where are we up to?" - this page answers, so the lead does not have to.

Phase	Pages	Owner	By when	Done
1. Decide the path & meet	3-5			☐
2. Measure the new home	6-10			☐
3. Sort, room by room	15-21			☐
4. Family claims & quotes	22-26			☐
5. Pack & label boxes	27, 43			☐
6. Move day & first week	28-29			☐
7. Close the old home	30-32			☐

THE THREE DATES THAT RUN EVERYTHING

Move-in day: _____

The day your parent sleeps in the new home. Everything counts back from here.

Old-home deadline: _____

Lease end, closing date, or the day the house must be empty - whichever is real.

House review date: _____

Path C families: the day the still-full house gets its next look. Write it now, while everyone agrees it matters.

IF THE PLAN SLIPS

Moves slip. A date moves, a helper cancels, a room is not ready. Cross the date out, write the new one, and keep going - a plan with crossings-out is still a plan. The only real failure is the plan that lives in one tired person's head.

Will It Fit? Measure the New Home First

For the moment before the truck is loaded - so nothing makes a round trip. Families have moved a parent in, then moved two-thirds of it back out three months later. This page is how that does not happen to you.

1 - THE NEW ROOMS (tape measure, ten minutes a room)

Room	Length	Width	Door width	Notes
Living area				
Bedroom				
Bathroom				
Closet / storage				

2 - ASK THE COMMUNITY FOR THESE IN WRITING, FIRST VISIT

- [ ] The restricted-items list (common ones: space heaters, extension cords, candles, loose rugs).
- [ ] How many furniture pieces each room may hold, and any size limits.
- [ ] What may be hung on walls, and the weight limit.
- [ ] What the room must look like on day one - what they set up, and what you do.

3 - THE FURNITURE TABLE

One row per big piece. If it does not fit, decide its next home now - page 15 gives every item a way out.

Furniture piece	Size L x W x H	Fits?	Which room	If not: goes to

The Community's Rules, in Writing

For the rules nobody mentions until a mover is standing in the doorway holding the wrong thing. Every community has a written list - your job is simply to get it early, copy it here, and sort against the real rules instead of guesses.

ASK FOR THESE DOCUMENTS ON THE FIRST VISIT

- [ ] The restricted-items list, in writing (not a verbal summary).
- [ ] The move-in checklist the community gives its own staff.
- [ ] Parking, elevator, and loading rules for move-in day - including any hours when moving is not allowed.
- [ ] The name and direct number of the person who answers move-in questions.

NOT ALLOWED IN THIS COMMUNITY (copy from their list)

ALLOWED, WITH LIMITS (item - the limit)

ROOM-BY-ROOM LIMITS

Room	Max. furniture pieces	Other limit
Living area		
Bedroom		
Bathroom		
Entry / hall		

If a beloved item is on the not-allowed list, that is the community's rule, not a family member's opinion - it lands softer said that way, and it has the advantage of being true. Page 19 gives cherished things that cannot move a way to stay in your parent's life anyway.

More Measurements and a Sketch of the New Home

For everything page 6 did not catch: the corners, the cupboards, and the wall the bed has to fit against. Sketch the main room below - a rough drawing with true numbers beats a beautiful one with guesses.

THE MEASUREMENTS THAT DECIDE ARGUMENTS

Widest doorway the furniture must pass through

Hallway turn - can a sofa-length piece get around it?

Bed wall: length, and where the outlets are

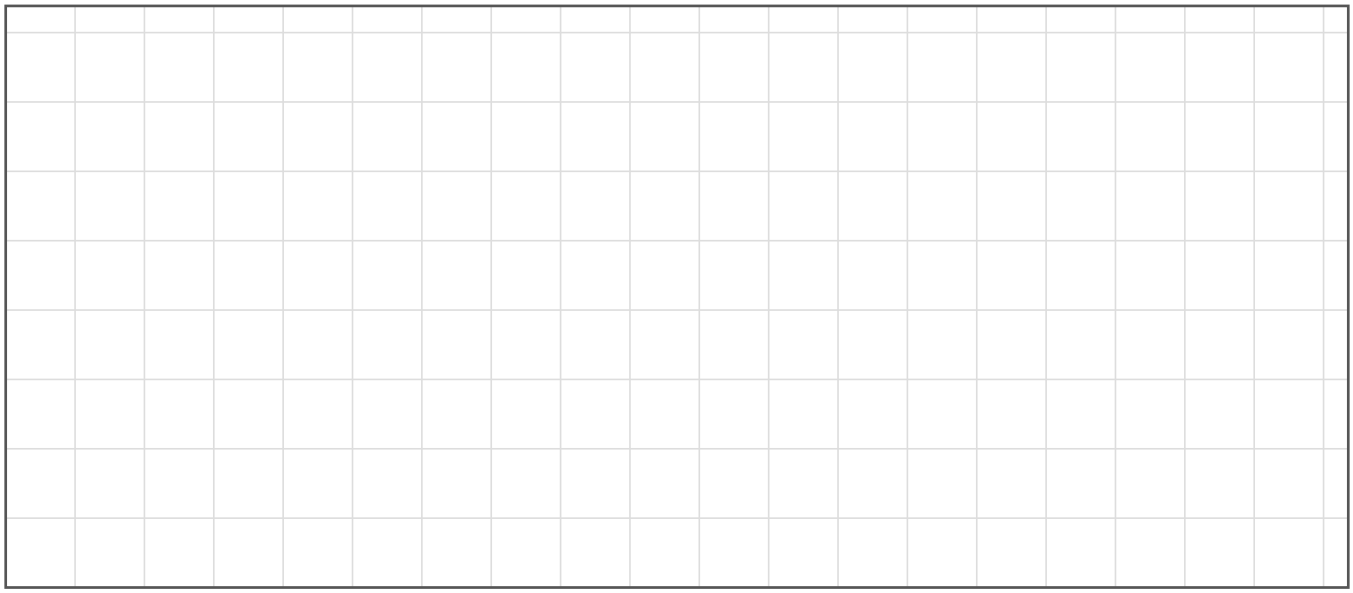
Closet: width, shelf heights, hanging space

Bathroom: door width, space beside the toilet, shower entry

Windows: sill height (what can sit under them)

SKETCH THE MAIN ROOM (one square = about one pace)

Room name:



Mark the door swing, the windows, and where the bed and the favourite chair will stand. Photograph this page and send it to whoever is packing - it ends most "will it fit?" phone calls.

Space Priorities: What Earns Its Place

For when the new home is half the size and everything feels equally precious. Small rooms are not a demotion - they are an edit. This page decides, corner by corner, what the new home does first, and what can wait or stay behind.

SET UP FIRST - THE ANCHORS (day one, no debate)

- [ ] The bed, made the way it is made at home (page 10).
- [ ] The favourite chair, in the spot with the best light.
- [ ] One wall of familiar faces - photos up before boxes are unpacked.
- [ ] The daily tools: glasses, remote, phone charger, the mug.

SET UP IN WEEK ONE

LEAVE EMPTY ON PURPOSE

An empty corner is not a failure to fill the room. It is room to breathe, space for the walker or the wheelchair turn, and somewhere for what turns out to be missed most. List the spaces you are deliberately leaving open:

IF IT CANNOT FIT AND CANNOT GO - THE HONEST OPTIONS

- A family member's home, with a review date - not "forever" by default (page 20).
- Photographed, its story written down, then let go with care (page 19).
- One storage unit, one named owner of the bill, one exit date (page 32). Two of those three missing means no unit.

Day One in the New Home

For the first afternoon, when the movers have gone and the room still smells new. The goal for day one is not "finished." The goal is one made bed, one familiar chair, one working lamp - and a parent who can find the bathroom in the night.

BEFORE YOUR PARENT ARRIVES

- [ ] Bed made, with their own bedding. Pillow from home if there is one.
- [ ] Lamp plugged in where their hand expects it. Clock set and readable.
- [ ] Bathroom ready: towels, toiletries, night-light if nights are dark.
- [ ] First Night Box (page 11) opened and put away - not left in its box.
- [ ] One framed photo standing up. It matters more than the tidy cupboards.
- [ ] Remote, glasses, phone and charger together in one known place.

WHO DOES WHAT IN THE FIRST TWO HOURS

Job	Person
Stays with your parent (not with the boxes)	
Bed and bathroom setup	
Boxes in, rubbish out	
Tea, food, and the first sit-down	
Paperwork with the community office	

LEAVE THE ROOM LIKE THIS

Bring your parent in when the anchors are ready - not to a room full of people unpacking around them. A calm first hour is worth three extra boxes unpacked.

The First Night Box - "Open Me First"

For move-in day, so the first night feels like a home and not a corridor. Pack this box last, open it first - and keep the medications and day-one papers with a person, never in the truck.

SLEEP

- [ ] Bedding for the first night: sheets, pillow, their blanket
- [ ] Pajamas and a change of clothes for the morning

WASH & TONIGHT'S ESSENTIALS

- [ ] Toiletries: toothbrush, soap, shampoo, razor
- [ ] Tonight's medications - in hand luggage, with the day's list
- [ ] Towels and a shower caddy if the bathroom is shared

MAKE IT FEEL LIKE THEIRS

- [ ] One framed photo, set up before anything else
- [ ] The familiar blanket, cushion, or chair cover from home
- [ ] A clock they can read, and the lamp they are used to
- [ ] Their mug, their tea or coffee, and how they take it

SMALL THINGS EVERY FAMILY WISHES THEY HAD

- [ ] A marker pen - label every piece of clothing with their name (the tip every experienced family passes on)
- [ ] Scissors, tape, and a spare roll of toilet paper
- [ ] Phone charger, plugged in where they can reach it
- [ ] Snacks and water for the people doing the moving

PAPERS FOR DAY ONE

- [ ] Photo ID and insurance cards (copies are fine here)
- [ ] The community's move-in paperwork and today's contact list

Familiar Rhythms: How a Day at Home Goes

For the small routines that make a place theirs. A new room becomes home faster when the day inside it keeps its old shape. Ask your parent - do not guess - and write it in their words where you can.

MORNING, THE WAY THEY LIKE IT

THE FAVOURITES

Tea / coffee - how exactly?

Breakfast - what, and when?

Radio, TV, music - which stations or channels?

The chair, the blanket, the cushion - which ones?

Evening - what does a good evening look like?

WHAT HELPS WHEN THE DAY IS HARD

A walk? A phone call with a particular person? Quiet, music, fresh air, being left alone for an hour? The things that settle your parent are knowledge the community team will thank you for.

PLEASE DON'T - THE SMALL THINGS THAT MATTER

A Note for the Community Team

For the people who will knock on your parent's door every day. Fill this in together, copy it, and leave the copy where staff will see it - on the whiteboard if the room has one. Experienced families call the whiteboard the most useful object in the room.

PLEASE CALL ME:

I LIKE TO BE UP AT / IN BED AT:

I TAKE MY TEA / COFFEE:

FOODS I LOVE / FOODS TO AVOID FOR ME:

HEARING / GLASSES - WHAT I NEED:

WHAT CALMS ME WHEN I AM UNSETTLED:

PLEASE DO NOT:

MY FAMILY CONTACT FOR ANYTHING:

This page carries comforts and preferences only - never medication instructions or care decisions. Those belong to the community's own records and professionals. If something here changes, update the copy in the room, not just this one.

Move-Day Contacts - Every Number on One Page

For move-in day, when nobody should be searching a phone with shaking hands. Fill it in the week before, photograph it, and send the photo to everyone involved.

Who / what	Name	Phone
The community - front desk		
The community - our move-in contac		
Moving company		
Move lead (family)		
Helper 1		
Helper 2		
Who holds the old-home keys		
Who holds the new-home keys		
Building / elevator booking		
Cleaner (old home)		
Donation pick-up		
In an emergency, call		

KEYS - WHO HAS WHAT, AS OF TODAY

Keys wander during moves. When a set changes hands, cross the old line out and write the new holder here - the crossed-out version is still useful history.

Six Ways an Item Can Go

For standing in a room with forty years of things in it. You do not have to decide everything today. You only have to decide the next box - and every item gets one of these six doors.

1 - MOVE

It fits the new home (page 6 says yes), and it is used or loved every week. This is the shortest list of the six.

2 - FAMILY

Someone in the family genuinely wants it. It goes on the Family Claims list (page 23), with one pick-up deadline for everyone.

3 - SELL

Worth the time it takes to sell, and there is time before the deadline. If selling it would take a month you do not have, it belongs in Donate.

4 - DONATE

Useful to someone else, today. Letting it go is a gift, not a loss - and a receipt page in the full kit keeps the record straight.

5 - LET GO

Worn out, broken, or kept "just in case" for twenty years. Some things have finished their job. They leave the house handled with care, the way everything your parent owned deserves.

6 - DECIDE LATER

Genuinely undecided - that is allowed. Two limits keep this door honest: at most two boxes, and a review date written on each box, chosen by your parent. On that date it goes to Family, Donate, or Let Go. No box rents a storage unit forever.

> One rule above all six: these are your parent's things. The final call on every item is theirs (page 33). This page just gives each item a door to walk through - it never pushes one through it.

Room by Room: The Living Room

For the room with the most shared memories in it. Go slower here than feels efficient - this room is where forty years of evenings live, and your parent knows where everything is and why it matters.

Work one room at a time, one surface at a time. For each item: which door (page 15), whose job, done. Photographing a shelf before you start is a kind way to decide with your parent without standing over the things themselves.

Item	Door (M/F/S/D/L/?) Owner	Done
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

USUALLY FOUND HERE - TICK AS YOU MEET THEM

- ☐ The favourite chair
- ☐ Photos and albums
- ☐ TV and remotes
- ☐ Books and magazines
- ☐ Lamps
- ☐ The good china / display shelf
- ☐ Games, cards, hobbies
- ☐ Cushions and throws

The living room is where the "matters most" item usually hides. If your parent names one thing here, it goes to the top of page 33 and the top of the moving list - before anything practical.

Room by Room: Bedroom and Closets

For the most private room in the house. Offer to leave the room while your parent goes through drawers alone first, if they would rather. Privacy is not inefficiency - it is how this room gets finished at all.

Work one room at a time, one surface at a time. For each item: which door (page 15), whose job, done. Photographing a shelf before you start is a kind way to decide with your parent without standing over the things themselves.

Item	Door (M/F/S/D/L/?) Owner	Done
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

USUALLY FOUND HERE - TICK AS YOU MEET THEM

- ☐ Clothes for this season
- ☐ Clothes put away / out of season
- ☐ Shoes and coats
- ☐ Jewellery and watches
- ☐ Bedside drawer
- ☐ Spare bedding and towels
- ☐ Suitcases and bags
- ☐ The wardrobe top shelf

Clothes that move get labelled with your parent's name (the marker pen, page 11) before they leave the old home - laundries in shared buildings mix things up in week one, and a name in the collar ends the confusion.

Room by Room: Kitchen, Bathroom and Storage

For the rooms full of duplicates, half-used bottles, and things kept for a house that cooked for six. New-home kitchens are small: the daily mug matters, the third roasting pan does not - and saying so is a measurement (page 6), not a judgment.

Work one room at a time, one surface at a time. For each item: which door (page 15), whose job, done. Photographing a shelf before you start is a kind way to decide with your parent without standing over the things themselves.

Item	Door (M/F/S/D/L/?) Owner	Done
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

USUALLY FOUND HERE - TICK AS YOU MEET THEM

- ☐ Daily dishes, mug, cutlery
- ☐ Pots used every week
- ☐ Small appliances
- ☐ Pantry - check every date
- ☐ Cleaning supplies
- ☐ Medicines cabinet (locations, p.30)
- ☐ Tools and the junk drawer
- ☐ Garage / attic / shed

Food and medicines: check dates as you sort, and ask the community or a pharmacist how they want medicines handed over on day one. This kit never advises on medication itself - it only keeps track of where things are.

Keepsake Story Cards

For the things that cannot move but must not simply vanish. Photograph the item, write its story in a sentence or two, and the memory stays - in an album your parent can hold - even when the object itself is let go with care.

One card per keepsake. Print this page as many times as you need. Your parent's own words are best; a grandchild's hand for the writing is a good second.

THE ITEM: _____ [photo]

ITS STORY (a sentence or two is enough):

_____

_____

WHERE IT GOES NOW: _____

THE ITEM: _____ [photo]

ITS STORY (a sentence or two is enough):

_____

_____

WHERE IT GOES NOW: _____

THE ITEM: _____ [photo]

ITS STORY (a sentence or two is enough):

_____

_____

WHERE IT GOES NOW: _____

Cards for the most-loved items make a small album - a kind first-week gift for the new room, and a record the whole family can keep copies of.

Decide Later - With Honest Limits

For the box that keeps a hard day moving. Undecided is allowed - it just needs a fence around it, or "later" quietly becomes a storage unit nobody opens and everybody pays for.

THE TWO RULES (from page 15)

- At most TWO Decide Later boxes for the whole move. When a third threatens, something in the first two gets decided.
- Every box gets a review date on its label, chosen by your parent - and the date goes in the family update (page 26), so it is not one person's secret.

THE BOXES

Box #	What is in it (honestly)	Review date	On that date it goes to

WHERE THE BOXES LIVE UNTIL THE REVIEW DATE

- ☐ In the new home, if there is truly space (page 9's empty corners are not storage in disguise).
- ☐ With a named family member who agreed out loud - write their name below.
- ☐ In storage only with an exit date already on page 32. No date, no unit.

The boxes will be kept at / by:

WHEN THE REVIEW DATE COMES

Open the box with your parent, somewhere comfortable, with tea. Each item takes one of the other five doors (page 15). Anything still undecided after a second honest look usually is decided - it is the box that was being kept, not the things.

Donation and Sale Record

For the paper trail that saves arguments in April. What left, where it went, who handled it, and where the receipt lives - one line each, written on the day, not reconstructed later from memory.

Item / group	Donated to / sold via	Date	Amount / receipt at

BEFORE ANYTHING LEAVES THE HOUSE

- [ ] Family Claims deadline (page 23) has passed - nobody's claimed item leaves by mistake.
- [ ] Your parent has seen this list, or the items on it, and said yes.
- [ ] Keepsakes worth a story have a card (page 19) and a photograph.

Keep receipts together in one envelope, and write where that envelope lives on page 30. This page records facts for your family's own keeping - for any tax question, a tax professional is the right person to ask.

Who Is Doing What - the Responsibility List

For the move where one person quietly does everything while everyone else assumes it is handled. A job with a name beside it is a job that gets done - and a job with nobody's name is now visible, while there is still time to ask for help.

Task	Owner	Helper	By	Done
Measure the new home (p.6)				☐
Get the rules in writing (p.7)				☐
Book the movers				☐
Run the family claims list (p.23)				☐
Sort: living room (p.16)				☐
Sort: bedroom (p.17)				☐
Sort: kitchen & storage (p.18)				☐
Pack & label the boxes				☐
First Night Box (p.11)				☐
Old-home clean-out & hand-back				☐
JOBS WITH NO NAME YET (the honest column)				

If one name fills most of the Owner column, that is information, not a complaint to swallow. Send a photo of this page with the weekly update (page 26) and ask, in writing, for two of the jobs to move. People help more when the ask is one named job with one date.

Family Claims - Who Wants What, By When

For the conversation that goes better in writing than in a group chat. One list, one deadline, the same date for everyone - it ends most of the arguing before it starts.

HOW THIS PAGE WORKS

1. List each item once, as it comes up while sorting (page 15).
2. Family members write their name against anything they truly want.
3. Set ONE claim deadline for everybody. Same date, no side deals.
4. Not picked up by the deadline? It moves to Donate or Sell - as your parent decides.

The claim deadline for our family is: _____

Item	Claimed by	Pick-up by	Picked up
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

Send a photo of this page to the whole family. One page and one deadline prevent the hardest sentence in this whole process: "I would have taken that, if anyone had asked me."

When You Cannot Agree - Park It, With a Date

For the item, or the decision, that stops the whole day. Disagreement is normal in this process - it usually means the thing matters to somebody. Write it down, name a date to come back to it, and keep the rest of the move moving.

What we cannot agree on	Who sees it differently	Revisit on	Decided
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

THREE WAYS THROUGH MOST STANDOFFS

Ask the owner.

It is your parent's item and your parent's move. Their call ends most arguments - the family's job is to make the call possible, not to make it for them.

Shrink the decision.

Not "keep the piano forever?" but "does the piano fit the new room (page 6)?" A measurable question is kinder than a values argument.

Time-box it.

If nobody can decide today, the item goes in a Decide Later box (page 20) with a date - agreed, written, and shared. The move does not stop for one object.

If a disagreement is really about money, inheritance, or who has "done more" over the years, this page will not settle it - and it is allowed to be settled somewhere else, later. The move only needs the boxes packed.

Vendors and Quotes - Compare Before You Commit

For the expensive week. Families under time pressure have paid thousands to whoever answered the phone first. Three quotes, written on one page, is usually an afternoon's work - and it is the cheapest afternoon of the whole move.

Service	Company	Quote	Includes / does not include
Movers - option 1			
Movers - option 2			
Clear-out / hauling			
Auction / estate sale			
Cleaning (old home)			
Storage (if truly neede			

ASK EVERY QUOTE THESE FOUR QUESTIONS

- [ ] Is that the full price - travel, stairs, packing materials, disposal fees?
- [ ] What is NOT included that families usually end up paying for?
- [ ] Are you insured, and what happens if something breaks?
- [ ] Can the date move if the community's room is not ready - and what does moving it cost?

WE CHOSE - AND WHY

The Weekly Family Update - One Page, Every Week

For the relatives who call to ask "is it done yet?" Send this page instead - one photo of it, once a week, to everyone. Ten calm minutes of writing replaces a week of separate phone calls, and nobody has to guess or worry in the gaps.

Week of: _____ **Written by:** _____

DONE THIS WEEK

NEXT WEEK

HOW YOUR PARENT IS DOING (share what they are happy to share)

ONE THING WE NEED (a named job, a date, or an item collected)

DATES COMING UP

Box Finder - Every Box, One Line

For move-in day, when someone calls out "where is the kettle?" - this page answers in ten seconds. Number every box. Write keywords, not essays.

Box #	What's inside (keywords)	Goes to	Open

In the "Open" column write 1st, 2nd, or Later. The First Night Box (page 11) is always 1st - mark it with a star as well as a number.

MORE BOXES (13-24)

Box #	What's inside (keywords)	Goes to	Open

On move-in day, tape a copy of this page inside the front door of the new home. Movers, family, and community staff can all answer their own questions from it.

Move-Day Command - the Day Itself, Hour by Hour

For the day with a truck in it. One person runs this page - usually not the person staying with your parent. Everyone else's job is to be where this page says they are.

WHERE EVERYONE IS

Role	Person
At the old home (last out, locks up)	
At the new home (receives, directs boxes)	
With your parent (the whole day - not optional)	
Driving / errands / food for everyone	

THE DAY, IN ORDER

- [ ] First Night Box and day-one papers travel with a person, never in the truck (page 11).
- [ ] Your parent leaves the old home before the carrying starts, or arrives at the new home after the anchors are set (page 10). Not standing in the box pile - that part is a rule, not a preference.
- [ ] Boxes go straight to their rooms (Box Finder, page 27, taped inside the front door).
- [ ] Bed made, lamp on, photo up. Then everyone sits down and eats something.
- [ ] Keys handed over and written down (page 14). Old-home meter photos taken, if needed.
- [ ] One person walks the old home last: every room, every cupboard, the top of every wardrobe.

TIMES (write the real ones, the night before)

Truck / movers arrive: _____ Your parent leaves the old home: _____

First load at the new home: _____ Old home empty & checked: _____

The First Week - a Seven-Day Check-In

For the end of week one, when the boxes are mostly gone and the real questions arrive. Sit down with your parent for twenty minutes. Most of what this page finds is small, fixable, and much easier now than at month three.

MISSING - things reached for and not there

TOO MUCH - things brought that the room does not need

No shame in this list - every family brings too much of something. It leaves calmly now, to Family or Donate (page 15), not in a stressed second move later.

ASK THE COMMUNITY - questions week one raised

WHAT IS ALREADY WORKING (say it out loud, too)

One good sign to look for: your parent directing a small thing themselves - moving a photo, asking for their chair by the window. The room is becoming theirs. That is the whole point of the first week.

Where the Important Papers Are

For the day a form asks a question, and the answer is in a drawer three rooms away - or three states away. One page that says where everything lives.

Locations only - never the numbers. Do not write account numbers, passwords, or ID numbers on this page, or anywhere in this planner. Where a thing is, and who holds it: that is all this page ever holds.

Document	Original is kept at	Copy held by	Checked
Will			
Power of attorney			
Advance health care directive			
House deed / lease papers			
Insurance policies			
Bank & pension paperwork			
Birth & marriage certificates			
Spare keys - who holds them			
Other:			

This page can keep track of where documents live. It cannot create or change any of them - for that, please talk to a lawyer or the community's office. If a row is empty because nobody knows, that empty row is useful: it is the first thing to ask about.

Closing the Old Home - the Finish Board

For the weeks after the move, when the old house still quietly needs things. One board, every job with a box to tick, so "done" is a fact and not a feeling.

- [ ] Final sort finished - nothing left "to deal with later" in the house itself
- [ ] Donation pick-ups completed (record on page 21)
- [ ] Clear-out / hauling done, and the house walked room by room
- [ ] Cleaning done (who, when - page 25 has the quote)
- [ ] Keys returned / handed over - to whom, on what date
- [ ] Mail redirected; address changed where it matters
- [ ] Utilities and services closed or transferred - confirmations kept
- [ ] Photos taken of the empty rooms (for the landlord, the sale, or just the family)
- [ ] The papers envelope - where it lives now (page 30 updated)
- [ ] One last look with your parent, if they want one - at their pace, or not at all

HAND-OVER NOTES (meter readings, landlord notes, anything factual)

Thirty Days Later - Review, and the Storage Exit

For one month in, over tea. A short look back, a short list forward - and if a storage unit is still being paid for, this is the page where its remaining days get a number.

THE NEW HOME, ONE MONTH IN

What feels like home already?

What is still missing or not working?

What did we bring too much of - any left to move out?

THE OLD HOME

STORAGE - THE EXIT, IN WRITING

- We are paying for storage: yes / no (circle one, honestly).
- What is in there, in one line - and who still wants any of it?
- Exit date - the unit is emptied and the contract ended by:

_____ On that date, contents go to Family, Donate, or Let Go (page 15).

Storage made sense as a bridge for a few weeks. As a second rent on a former life, it quietly drains money and keeps the move unfinished. An exit date written here, and shared with the family (page 26), is what turns the bridge back into a bridge.

Your Parent Decides

This page belongs to your parent - fill it in together, in their words, at their pace. It is their home and their things. You are here to help it happen, not to take it over.

THREE THINGS THAT ARE DEFINITELY COMING WITH ME

THE ONE PIECE THAT MATTERS MOST TO ME

(A chair, a table, a clock - and, if you like, why.)

THINGS I WOULD LIKE TO GIVE TO SPECIFIC PEOPLE

To (name)	The item

THINGS I AM READY TO LET GO OF

ONE THING I WANT MY FAMILY TO UNDERSTAND ABOUT THIS MOVE

For the family member helping: "undecided" is a complete answer. It goes in a Decide Later box (page 15), with a date your parent chooses. Nothing on this page has to be finished today.

A Page for You - the One Doing This

For the adult child reading this at midnight, between a full-time job and a full house. Every other page in this kit is about the move. This one is about the person carrying it - briefly, and without a pep talk.

You are not behind.

There is no schedule for this that real families meet. There is a move-in date, and there is everything else, which takes the time it takes.

Help is a tool, not a surrender.

Cleaners, movers, an organizer for one room, a sibling asked for one named job (page 22). Using help is how this gets finished - it was never a test of devotion.

Guilt is not a measurement.

Feeling guilty does not mean you did it wrong. A parent can be sad about a move and the move can still be right, at the same time, on the same day.

Rest is part of the plan.

One evening a week that is not about the move. The house will still be there tomorrow; you need to be, too.

WHEN TO PAUSE AND CALL IN MORE HELP

- [ ] You have not slept properly in two weeks and the move is not nearly done.
- [ ] A family disagreement has stopped being about furniture (page 24).
- [ ] Paperwork questions keep turning into legal or care questions - those belong to professionals, kindly and firmly (page 2).

ONE LINE FOR YOURSELF

What would "done well enough" look like for your family - not perfectly, not like anyone else's move. Well enough.

Quick Start: Your First Week on One Page

For when there is no time to read a whole kit. This page is the entire first week, in roughly this order. Cross things off as they happen - and if the week goes sideways, as weeks do, the plan bends. It does not break.

- [ ] **1. Pick your path (page 3)**
  Planned, two-week, or move-first-sort-later. Tell the family which one it is, in one message.

- [ ] **2. Visit the new home (page 6)**
  Measure the rooms, and leave with the written list of what can and cannot be brought.

- [ ] **3. Start the papers page (page 30)**
  Locations only. Ten minutes. The empty rows tell you what to ask about next.

- [ ] **4. Send the Family Claims page (page 23)**
  One list, one deadline, the same date for everyone - before any sorting starts.

- [ ] **5. Sit down with your parent (page 33)**
  Their three things, their one piece that matters most. Their call, your help.

- [ ] **6. Write the First Night Box list (page 11)**
  The box itself can be packed later in the week. The list cannot wait.

- [ ] **7. Book the help, gather the numbers**
  Movers, helpers, the community's office - every phone number for move day on one page (page 14), shared with everyone involved.

That is a week. The rest of the kit is there when you need it - one page at a time, in the order your move needs it, not the order it is printed in.

Quick Start: the Planned Path, Week by Week

For Path A families (page 3) - about six to eight weeks, and a job, and a life. One focus per week is the whole secret. If a week collapses, the next week simply starts where this one stopped.

Weeks 1-2: Measure and meet.
New home measured (p.6-8). Rules in writing (p.7). First family conversation held (p.4). Your parent's page started (p.33).

Weeks 3-4: Sort the big rooms.
Living room and bedroom, one surface at a time (p.16-17). Family Claims list sent, deadline set (p.23). Keepsakes get story cards as they surface (p.19).

Week 5: Sort the working rooms.
Kitchen, bathroom, storage (p.18). Vendor quotes compared (p.25). Decide Later boxes sealed - two, no more (p.20).

Week 6: Pack and label.
Boxes numbered as they close (p.27). First Night Box packed last, labelled with a star (p.11). Contacts page sent to everyone (p.14).

Move week.
Move-Day Command page runs the day (p.28). Day One anchors first (p.10). Seven-day check-in booked (p.29).

After: close and review.
Old home finish board (p.31). Thirty-day review - and the storage exit, if there is one (p.32).

Working full-time alongside this? Halve each week's ambition, not your sleep. The path stretches; the order stays the same.

Quick Start: the Two-Week Sprint - and Move First

For Path B and Path C families (page 3). When the date is close, or the house must wait: less sorting, more honesty. Only the essentials travel. Everything else gets a date, not a disappearance.

THE TWO-WEEK SPRINT (Path B)

- [ ] Days 1-2: Measure only the furniture that cannot come back (p.6). Get the restricted list in writing (p.7).
- [ ] Days 3-5: Your parent's page (p.33). First Night Box list (p.11). Papers page (p.30) - locations only.
- [ ] Days 6-10: Pack essentials and the furniture that fits. Everything else is labelled with its door (p.15) or boxed as Decide Later (p.20).
- [ ] Days 11-14: Contacts page out (p.14). Move day run from page 28. House sorting continues after move-in, on the Planned rhythm (p.36).

MOVE FIRST, SORT LATER (Path C)

- [ ] Move day takes: bed, chair, clothes for two weeks, medicines with a person, papers page, First Night Box. That is the whole truck ambition.
- [ ] The house stays locked and insured, keys with one named person (p.14). Nothing is decided in the empty-house weeks except on sorting days.
- [ ] Sorting days are booked like appointments - two or three a week, one room each (p.16-18), family update after each one (p.26).
- [ ] House review date (p.5) is fixed before move day. If it slips once, it gets a new date the same week - it does not drift.

Both of these paths are real plans, used by real families every week. A smaller, finished move beats a perfect, unfinished one - every time it is tried.

A Worked Example: One Family's Move, Start to Finish

A fictional family - any resemblance is the resemblance of every family that has done this. Read it once, and the rest of the kit will feel familiar when your turn comes. The filled example file in your download shows three of their pages, completed.

The start.

Rosa Alvarez, 78, is moving from the house she has lived in for 34 years to a one-room apartment at an assisted living community across town. Her daughter Mia coordinates around a full-time job; her son Daniel lives two hours away. They choose Path A - six weeks (page 3) - and hold the first conversation at Rosa's kitchen table, with Rosa's non-negotiable written down first: "My chair comes. And nobody throws anything away without asking me."

Measure first.

At the first visit, Mia measures (page 6) and asks for the restricted list in writing (page 7). The verdict is quick: the chair fits; the dresser fits; the tall bookcase does not - the door and the turn say no. Rosa decides the bookcase goes to Daniel. Nobody discovers this on move day, with the bookcase in a truck.

Sorting, calmly.

One room a week (pages 16-18). The Family Claims page goes out with one deadline (page 23) - Daniel claims the bookcase and the toolbox; a niece claims the good china. Two boxes, and only two, are marked Decide Later, with a review date Rosa chose herself (page 20). Three keepsakes that cannot move get story cards, in Rosa's words (page 19).

Move day.

Daniel stays with Rosa and takes her to lunch. Mia runs page 28 at the new home, the Box Finder taped inside the door (page 27). The First Night Box - star on the side - is opened first. By supper the bed is made with Rosa's own bedding, the chair sits by the window, and one photograph is already on the wall.

One month on.

The seven-day check (page 29) found two things missing and one too many. The thirty-day review (page 32) closed the old house, set the storage exit - there was no storage, which pleased everyone - and opened the first Decide Later box, with tea, exactly as the rules said.

Command Sheets: Your Move on One Dashboard

For the kitchen table. Everything the family usually keeps in separate notebooks and group chats - the phases, the people, the money, the boxes - watched from two pages. Fill these in from the detailed pages as you go.

PHASE DASHBOARD (mirror of page 5 - keep both in step)

Phase	Status: not started / going / done	Blocked by
1. Path & first meeting		
2. Measure the new home		
3. Sort, room by room		
4. Claims, quotes & vendors		
5. Pack & label		
6. Move day & week one		
7. Close the old home		

THE NUMBERS THAT KEEP THE PEACE

Total boxes packed so far: _____

First Night Box packed and starred: _____

Family Claims deadline: _____

Move-in date: _____

Update this page when you send the weekly family update (page 26). Same numbers, same story, for everybody - that is most of what a command center is for.

Command Sheets: Money and Paper Trail at a Glance

For the questions that arrive months later: what did the move cost, who paid for what, and where is the receipt. Ten honest lines now; no reconstruction project later.

MOVE BUDGET - ESTIMATE, ACTUAL, SETTLED

Category	Estimate	Actual	Paid by
Movers			
Clear-out / hauling			
Cleaning			
Storage (if any)			
Boxes & supplies			
Travel & food on move days			
Other			

HOW IT GETS SETTLED BETWEEN US (in writing, kindly)

WHERE THE RECEIPTS LIVE

The envelope / folder / drawer is:

This page tracks a family's own spending and receipts. It is bookkeeping, not financial or tax advice - for anything about deductibility or estates, a professional is the right person to ask (page 2).

AI Photo Inventory Cards (1 of 2)

For turning photographs into a first draft of a list, instead of a blank page. Use any AI assistant you already have. The cards do the asking; you stay the editor - and the decider.

CARD 1 - A ROOM PHOTO BECOMES AN INVENTORY DRAFT

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"Here is a photo of one room. List every visible item, one per line: item, approximate size, and where it stands in the room. Do not guess at value. Flag anything you cannot identify as 'unclear'."

1. One room, one photo at a time. Daylight helps; open cupboards separately.
2. Copy the draft into the room page (p.16-18). Then walk the room and correct it - the draft is a start, never the record.

Watch for: invented items. If it is not in the photo, cross it out.

CARD 2 - A SHELF OR DRAWER AT A TIME

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"Here is a close photo of one shelf. List the items left to right, in plain words, grouped as: used often / sometimes / not in years - only if the photo shows it. If unsure, say so."

1. Small areas give honest lists. Whole rooms in one photo do not.
2. Sorting decisions still happen with your parent, on page 15 - the list never decides.

Watch for: tidy lies - a neat list of a messy shelf is still a guess.

CARD 3 - FROM SPOKEN NOTES TO A SORTED LIST

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"I will dictate what is in a room. Turn my words into a table: item / where it is / what I said about it. Keep my exact words in the third column. Do not add advice."

1. Walk the room with your parent and talk. Their words, kept exact, carry the decisions later.
2. Paste the result into the room pages. This is the kindest card for a parent who dislikes forms.

Watch for: softened words. If your parent said 'never used it', the list should not say 'rarely used'.

The lines that hold on every card: never photograph faces, documents, medication labels, or anything with account or ID numbers. AI output is a draft - a person checks every line and makes every decision. These cards never ask AI to value an item, and never let it decide what is kept or let go.

AI Photo Inventory Cards (2 of 2)

Three more drafts an assistant can make for you - a listing, a family update, and a first-night check - each with the same rule: it drafts, you decide.

CARD 4 - A SALE LISTING DRAFT (facts only)

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"From this photo and my notes, draft a short sale listing: what it is, measurements, condition, and honest flaws. Do not suggest a price. List what a buyer would still need to ask."

1. You set the price, from your quotes and judgement (p.25). The draft only describes.
2. Record the sale on page 21 the day it happens.

Watch for: polished flaws. If the leg wobbles, the listing says the leg wobbles.

CARD 5 - THE WEEKLY FAMILY UPDATE, DRAFTED

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"From these rough notes, draft a one-page family update with four headings: Done this week / Next week / How our parent is doing / One thing we need. Keep it warm and short. Change no facts."

1. Paste your scribbles from the week; read the draft against them before sending (p.26).
2. Anything about your parent's health or feelings goes in only as they would want it shared.

Watch for: added optimism. The draft reports the week; it does not decorate it.

CARD 6 - CHECK A ROOM PHOTO AGAINST THE FIRST-NIGHT LIST

SAY OR PASTE THIS:

"Here is my First Night Box list (pasted below) and a photo of the packed box. Tell me which listed items you cannot see, and which visible items are not on the list. Do not suggest extras."

1. The list is page 11, filled in by your family. The check is a second pair of eyes, nothing more.
2. Pack the box last; photograph it before it is taped shut.

Watch for: confidence about hidden layers. It can only check what the photo shows.

The lines that hold on every card: never photograph faces, documents, medication labels, or anything with account or ID numbers. AI output is a draft - a person checks every line and makes every decision. These cards never ask AI to value an item, and never let it decide what is kept or let go.

Printable Box Labels - Cut, Tape, Done

Print this page as many times as you need. Patterns, not colours, carry the meaning, so black-and-white printing loses nothing. Write the box number big - the Box Finder (page 27) does the rest.

##########

MOVE

solid bar - to the new home

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

//////////

FAMILY

stripes - claimed, awaiting pick-up

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

.....

SELL

dots - to be sold

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

==========

DONATE

open box - to be given

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

LET GO

plain - handled with care

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

- - -- - -- - -- - -- - -

DECIDE LATER

dashed - review date on the label

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

****

OPEN FIRST

star - the First Night Box

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

_____

_____

blank - your own word

Box #: _____

Room / date: _____

The Decide Later label is not finished until its review date is written on it (page 20). A label without a date is how storage units are born.